IELTS FOUNDATION · UNIT 3

Hobbies, Leisure and Entertainment

Free time, sports and what is happening now

Vocabulary | Grammar | Reading | Listening | Writing | Speaking

Mindset for IELTS Foundation · Unit 3 · Book pp. 34–46

LEARNING GOAL

Talk and write about free time, sports and what is happening now

Objectives: you will...

- name leisure activities and sports
- listen for specific information in a conversation
- use the present simple and the present continuous
- skim an article for the main idea
- describe pictures with both tenses
- write a message in reply to a friend

Success criteria: I can...

- use play, do and go with the right activities
- listen to all three options before I choose
- use the present simple for habits and the present continuous for now
- say what an article is mainly about
- tell False and Not Given apart
- write a short message about what is happening

IELTS STRATEGIES

Test habits to build in this unit

LISTENING

You will hear information about **all three** options, but only **one** is correct.

Box, p. 35 · Mini tip 05.0

LISTENING

The words in the options are **different** from the words you hear. Listen for the meaning.

Box, p. 35 · Mini tip 05.1

GRAMMAR IN EVERY PAPER

Show that you understand **different tenses** and can use them in sentences, conversations and longer texts.

Box, p. 37

LEAD-IN

Fun, scary or boring?

1 · List

Write 6 free-time activities in 60 seconds.

2 · Sort

Put each one in a group: fun, scary or boring.

3 · Compare

“I think climbing is scary because…” Do you agree?

VOCABULARY

Play, do or go?

play + ball games	do + martial arts, exercise	go + -ing activities
football	judo	swimming
basketball	karate	cycling
badminton	yoga	hiking
chess	gymnastics	sailing

Quick test: does it end in *-ing*? Use *go*. Does it use a ball (or a board)? Use *play*. Otherwise, try *do*.

VOCABULARY

Sports verbs and people

hit / kick / throw

Hit with a racket or bat. Kick with your foot. Throw with your hand.

score / catch

Score a goal or points. Catch the ball in your hands.

win / beat / lose

You **win** a match. You **beat** a team. You **lose** a match.

racket / bat

Tennis and badminton: racket. Cricket and baseball: bat.

coach / referee

A coach trains you. A referee controls the match.

professional / fit

A professional is paid to play. Fit = healthy and strong.

GRAMMAR · FORM AND USE

Present simple or present continuous?

Present simple: habits

I **play** tennis every Saturday.

She **doesn’t go** swimming in winter.

always, usually, every day, on Mondays

Present continuous: now

I**’m watching** the match right now.

In this photo, we**’re climbing**.

now, at the moment, today, Look!

IELTS STRATEGY

Show that you understand **different tenses** and can use them in sentences, conversations and longer texts.

GRAMMAR · QUESTIONS AND SHORT ANSWERS

Do you…? or Are you…?

	Present simple	Present continuous
Question	Do you play chess?	Are you playing chess now?
Short answer	Yes, I do. / No, I don’t.	Yes, I am. / No, I’m not.
Wh- question	When does he train?	What is he doing?
Auxiliary	do / does	am / is / are

Match the answer to the question: a *do* question gets a *do* answer; a *be* question gets a *be* answer.

GRAMMAR · SPELLING

Adding -s and -ing

Rule	he / she / it	-ing
most verbs	play → plays	play → playing
ends in -e	ride → rides	ride → riding
consonant + vowel + consonant	swim → swims	swim → swimming
consonant + y	carry → carries	carry → carrying
ends in -ie	lie → lies	lie → lying

Watch out: *run* → *running*, *get* → *getting*, *stop* → *stopping*, but *visit* → *visiting*.

GRAMMAR · COMMON MISTAKES

Verbs we don’t use with -ing

State verbs

like · love · hate · want · know · understand · remember · believe · belong

Right or wrong?

× I’m not understanding the question.

✓ I don’t understand the question.

× This book is belonging to Sam.

✓ This book belongs to Sam.

READING SKILL

Skim first, then read for detail

1 · Look
Title and photos
Who or what is it about?

2 · Skim
Read once, quickly
Don’t stop at new words.

3 · Say it
The main idea
One sentence: “It’s about…”

4 · Read
Then the details
Now answer the questions.

Try it: you have 60 seconds to skim the article. Then close the book and tell a partner what it is about.

READING · TRUE, FALSE OR NOT GIVEN

Same, opposite, or missing?

> “Leo plays basketball for his school team. They train on Tuesdays and Thursdays. He wants to be a coach one day.”

Statement	Answer
Leo trains twice a week.	**True**: the same meaning
Leo trains every day.	**False**: the opposite
Leo’s team won last season.	**Not Given**: the text doesn’t say

LISTENING · MULTIPLE CHOICE

You hear all three. Only one is right.

When does the match start?

A 2:00 B 2:30 C 3:00

“The poster says two o’clock, but that’s when the gates open. The players come out half an hour later. We should leave by three.”

Answer: B (half an hour later = 2:30)

IELTS STRATEGY

You will hear about **all three** options, but only one is correct.

The options use **different words**: listen for the meaning.

WRITING

Replying to a message from a friend

Where are you?

Who are you with?

What are you doing?

What is happening?

Where can you meet?

What should they bring?

Before you write: make notes from the information you have (a poster, a message), then answer **every** point.

WRITING · MODEL

A reply in about 50 words

Hi Dan,

I’m at the beach with my cousins. We**’re playing** volleyball and some people **are swimming**. There’s music and the food **smells** great! Come and join us. Meet me next to the blue café at four. Bring a towel **because** the water is really warm.

See you soon,
Nina

Present continuous for now

State verb in the simple form

Where to meet and **what to bring**, with a reason

SPEAKING · IELTS PART 1

Talking about hobbies and sport

Make it longer

Answer: I love playing badminton.

Habit: I usually play with my dad on Sundays.

Reason: It’s fast and it keeps me fit.

What do you like doing in your free time?

Which sports do you like watching on TV?

Is it important to spend time outdoors? Why?

Are you learning a new hobby at the moment?

SPEAKING

Describing a picture

Where?

In the middle… · On the left / right… · At the back… · Next to the…

What is happening?

A man **is riding** a bike. Two girls **are playing** frisbee. Nobody **is swimming**.

Spot the difference: “In my picture the dog is running, but in yours it’s sleeping.”

PAIR PRACTICE

Guess the sport

Student A

Choose a sport. Describe it, but don’t say its name.

Student B

Ask yes / no questions: Do you use a racket? Do you play in a team?

Then

Guess in 5 questions or fewer. Swap roles.

REVIEW

Can you…?

- Use play, do and go with 9 activities
- Choose the present simple or continuous
- Avoid -ing with like, know, understand
- Say what an article is mainly about
- Tell False and Not Given apart
- Listen to all three options before you choose

Next: take the *Unit 3 Challenge* on Miss L Gems and submit your PDF on Google Classroom.